

Current Affairs Class -6

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In NEWS: ‘PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana (PMSGMBY)’ has achieved a historic milestone with **10 lakh homes now solar-powered** as of 10th March 2025.

About PMSGMBY :

- It aims to provide free electricity to households in India.
- Launched on **February 15, 2024**.
- vision to supply solar power to **one crore households by March 2027**.

Features:

Under the scheme, households will be provided with a subsidy to install solar panels on their roofs.

The subsidy will cover up to 40% of the cost of the solar panels.

Benefits

Suitable Rooftop Solar Plant Capacity for households

Average Monthly Electricity Consumption (units)	Suitable Rooftop Solar Plant Capacity	Subsidy Support
0-150	1-2 kW	₹ 30,000/- to ₹ 60,000/-
150-300	2-3 kW	₹ 60,000/- to ₹ 78,000/-
> 300	Above 3 kW	₹ 78,000/-

Eligibility:

- The household must be an Indian citizen.
- The household must own a house with a roof that is suitable for installing solar panels.
- The household must have a valid electricity connection.
- The household must not have availed any other subsidy for solar panels.

Key benefits:

- Free Electricity for Households:
- Reduced Electricity Costs for the Government: Can save the government an estimated ₹75,000 crore annually in electricity costs.
- Increased Use of Renewable Energy
- Reduced Carbon Emissions

In News: The Ministry of Education (MoE) and the National Book Trust (NBT) of India launched the third edition of the Prime Minister's **Young Authors Mentorship Scheme, known as YUVA 3.0**, on March 11, 2025

About YUVA 3.0:

- The initiative aims to nurture young writers under **30 years of age**, providing them with mentorship and exposure to hone their creative writing skills.
- The scheme will help to develop a stream of writers who can write on various facets of India encompassing the **past, present and future**.
- Besides, the scheme will also provide a window to the aspiring youth to articulate themselves and present a comprehensive outlook of contribution of Indians across fields in ancient and present times.

Selection Process:

- The scheme invites applications from aspiring writers **through MyGov India's online portal.**
- A competitive process shortlists **50 young authors** based on a well-defined evaluation criterion.
- The **National Book Trust (NBT)** will constitute the selection committee.
- Applicants are required to submit a book proposal of **10,000 words, which is then reviewed by a panel.**
- The shortlisted candidates undergo a multi-stage selection process before the final selection.

Mentorship and Support:

- Selected authors receive a **mentorship program spanning six months.**
- The authors undergo workshops, interactions with mentors, and exposure to India's literary ecosystem.
- They receive financial assistance of **₹50,000 per month for six months.**
- Their works are published and promoted by the **NBT in multiple languages.**
- Under the mentorship, a National Camp will be held for the PM-YUVA 3.0 Authors during the New Delhi World Book Fair 2026.
- Selected authors get the opportunity to present their work at literary festivals and international forums.

In NEWS: The Centre has recently accorded approval for the ambitious **Chandrayaan-5 mission** to study the Moon

Achievements:

The Chandrayaan mission consists of studying the lunar surface.

Chandrayaan-1-

- It was successfully launched in 2008, made chemical, mineralogical and photo-geologic maps of the Moon.

Chandrayaan-2

- The mission in 2019 concluded when its lunar lander crashed on the moon's surface.

Chandrayaan 3:

- The Chandrayaan-3 mission was a follow-on mission to Chandrayaan-2, to demonstrate end-to-end capability in safe landing and roving on the lunar surface.

The mission achieved in landing **Vikram lander successfully** on the **moon's south pole region** on August 23, 2023.

Chandrayaan-4 mission:

It is expected to be launched in 2027. It will aim to collect samples of the **lunar soil from the moon and bring the back to the earth for further study.**

Chandrayaan-5 mission:

Unlike the Chandrayaan-3 mission which carried the **25-kg** rover '**Prayagyaan**', the Chandrayaan-5 mission would carry a **250 kg rover to study the Moon's surface**

Similar Projects in the ISRO Pipeline:

Gaganyaan:

Gaganyaan project envisages demonstration of human spaceflight capability by **launching crew of 3 members** to an orbit of **400 km for a 3 days mission** and bring them back safely to earth, by landing in Indian sea waters.

NASA astronauts Sunita Williams and Butch Wilmore return to Earth:

Spacecraft:

- The **Starliner spacecraft** carried NASA astronauts **Sunita Williams and Butch Wilmore** to the International Space Station (ISS) in June 2024 and its return journey to Earth was initially scheduled for June 26.
- However Starliner, developed problems after which it was considered unsafe for the astronauts' return.
- While Starliner itself returned safely to Earth in September 2024, the two astronauts were stranded on the ISS, waiting for an alternative travel arrangement

Persons return from Space station:

Now, a **SpaceX Dragon spacecraft**, which carried four astronauts to the ISS on a routine assignment, is bringing back Williams and Wilmore on its return journey.

Two other astronauts, **Nick Hague and Aleksandr Gorbunov**, who have completed their time on the ISS, are also returning with Williams and Wilmore.

Nine months in space

- Williams and Wilmore will come back after more than nine months — 286 days — in space.

About International Space Station (ISS):

- The International Space Station (ISS) is a modular space station in **low Earth orbit**, serving as a **research laboratory for microgravity and space environment studies**.
- It is a joint project involving multiple space agencies.

Participating Space Agencies

- NASA (USA)
- Roscosmos (Russia)
- JAXA (Japan)
- ESA (European Space Agency)
- CSA (Canada)

Features:

- The ISS orbits Earth at an altitude of ~400 km.
- It travels at a speed of ~28,000 km/h, orbiting Earth every 90 minutes.
- It has been continuously occupied since November 2000.

Functions & Objectives

Microgravity Research: Conducts scientific experiments in a low-gravity environment.

Astronomical Observations: Helps study cosmic rays, dark matter, and Earth's climate.

Technology Testing: Tests new space technology for future deep-space missions.

International Collaboration: A model for global cooperation in space.

Structure & Components:

- The ISS consists of multiple pressurized modules for crew habitation, laboratories, and solar arrays for power.
- Notable Modules: Zvezda (Russia), Destiny (USA), Columbus (ESA), Kibo (Japan).

India & ISS

- India is not a part of the ISS program but collaborates with NASA on space research.
- ISRO is planning its own space station **Bharatiya Antariksha Station (BAS)**, expected

In NEWS: Union Government launched **Pratibimb**

Recent initiative to curb Cyber crime:

Jurisdiction:

‘Police’ and ‘Public Order’ are State subjects as per the Seventh Schedule of the Constitution of India.

The States/UTs are primarily responsible for the prevention, detection, investigation and prosecution of crimes including cyber crime and setting up of hi-tech cyber cell through their Law Enforcement Agencies (LEAs).

Steps taken by the Union Government:

The Ministry of Home Affairs has set up the **‘Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre’ (I4C)** as an attached office to deal with all types of cyber crimes in the country, in a coordinated and comprehensive manner.

‘Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre’ (I4C):

- Indian Cybercrime Coordination Centre scheme was approved on 05th October 2018.

Objectives of I4C:

- To act as a nodal point to curb Cybercrime in the country.
- To strengthen the fight against Cybercrime committed against **women and children**.
- Facilitate easy filing Cybercrime related **complaints and identifying Cybercrime trends and patterns**.
- To act as an early warning system for Law Enforcement Agencies for proactive Cybercrime prevention and detection.
- Awareness creation among public about preventing Cybercrime.
- Assist States/UTs in capacity building of Police Officers, Public Prosecutors and Judicial Officers in the area of cyber forensic, investigation, cyber hygiene, cyber-criminology, etc.

- **Samanvaya Platform:**

It has been made operational to serve as an Management Information System(MIS) platform, data repository and a coordination platform for **LEAs** for cybercrime data sharing and analytics.

- **BHARATPOL portal :**

- The **National Central Bureau (NCB) in the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI)** acted as effective interface between Indian LEAs and foreign LEAs and facilitates regular exchange of information through INTERPOL channels.

Recently BHARATPOL portal has been launched to further streamline the communication between NCB, CBI and Indian LEAs in the matters of international assistance and coordination.

Pratibimb:

- It is a **Geographic Information System (GIS)-based** software launched by the Union Home Ministry's Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre (I4C).
- The module 'Pratibimb' maps locations of criminals and crime infrastructure on a map to give visibility to jurisdictional officers
- It provides analytics based on interstate linkages of crimes and criminals involved in cybercrime complaints across various States/UTs.

UN80 Initiative:

- Launched on the 80th anniversary of the UN by Secretary-General Antonio Guterres.

Purpose:

- It is a reform strategy to **boost efficiency and reduce costs within the United Nations.**
- It will also review the implementation of all mandates given to the UN by member states, which have significantly increased in recent years.

Aim:

- Improve financial sustainability amid shrinking global contributions.
- Enhance structural reforms for better mandate implementation.
- Strengthen strategic planning and cost-effectiveness.

In NEWS: Finance Ministry notifies 10-year Zero Coupon Bond of Power Finance Corporation

New Zero coupon Bond:

How Bond works?

- Bonds are a fundamental component of the fixed-income investment, representing a loan made by investors to borrowers, typically corporations or government entities.
- In general When an issuer needs to raise funds, whether for infrastructure projects, operational costs, or other financial needs, they issue bonds as a means of borrowing.
- In return, investors receive periodic interest payments, known as **coupon payments**, along with the principal amount upon maturity.
- Bonds come in various types, each catering to different investment objectives and risk profiles.

About Zero Coupon Bond:

- Zero-coupon bonds (ZCB), also known as **discount bonds**, are issued at a discount on the bond's face value and do not pay periodic interest to bondholders.
- On maturity, the bondholder receives the face value of his investment. In simple words, the investor purchasing a zero coupon bond profits from the difference between the buying price and the face value.

A bond's face value refers to how much a bond will be worth on its maturity date. In other words, it's the value that the bondholder will receive when their investment fully matures (assuming that the issuer doesn't call the bond or default).

For example: Assume you invest in a 2-year Zero-Coupon bond with a face value of ₹1000 and its current market price being ₹980. In this case, the YTM would be 1.015%.

Important Days:

1. International day of action for river:

- It is observed on **14 March** to spread awareness about the importance of rivers and climate change.
- It is dedicated to solidarity when several communities across the world come together with one voice to say that rivers matter.

Theme:

- The **"Water for All" theme** goes beyond simply raising awareness about the importance of rivers. It delves deeper into two crucial aspects:

World Consumer Rights Day:

- It is observed annually on **March 15**
- World Consumer Rights Day was first observed in 1983
- **Theme for World Consumer Rights Day 2025** is, '***A Just Transition to Sustainable Lifestyles.***' This theme reflects the urgent need to make sustainable and healthy lifestyle choices available, accessible, and affordable for all consumers.

E-Daakhil:

It is an innovative online platform designed to streamline the consumer grievance redressal process, providing an efficient and convenient way for consumers to approach the relevant consumer forum, dispensing the need to travel and be physically present to file their grievances.

No Smoking Day 2025:

No Smoking Day is an annual health awareness day observed to encourage smokers to quit smoking and to raise awareness about the health risks associated with tobacco use.

It is typically observed on the second Wednesday of March, In 2025, No Smoking Day falls on **March 12**.

